

- Travel improving - will people be outsourcing and meeting/dating people from around the world
 - Think about how on dating apps now you can put a radius of how close people are or if you're travelling you can change your location
- *The Good Place* - concept that they are paired with their soulmate in heaven → main characters did not speak the same language but it was "automatically translated"
 - apple airpods now have translating feature to automatically translate other languages for you
- Look at dating shows now
 - The age differences show... are people living longer and can date at drastically different age now... is medical technology advancing so that women can have kids later
- Technology impact on people today...less
- Climate change → not wanting to bring people into the world/have kids
- Pushing back age where people get married
- are there stats on increasing use of dating apps → can this tie into the AI stats
 - if its going down → ties into our idea of people being alone in the future

Social, economic, environmental

<https://www.wgsn.com/insight/article/69aee8262a6d96555356f46c>

- **Gen Z 2027: Companionship as a Service**
- talks about Gen Z's growing trust with AI and how that could move forward into AI relationships/companionship

!!!! <https://www.wgsn.com/insight/article/69663117ded3a15c6cf5d92b>

- **Youth Priorities 2027**
- also talks about companionship with AI
- talks a lot about characteristics of the younger generations, their current traits, and where they're headed

<https://www.wgsn.com/tech/article/69df9c0d4faec9e57d48c7ec>

- **Trend Alert: Apps for the Shared Table**
- talks about hybrid technology increasing
- younger generations are lonely and wanting more experiences and ways to meet new people
 - article talks about meeting people where you can dine with them using hybrid technology

<https://www.wgsn.com/insight/article/6901207976e6074b32dd7b34>

- **Valentine's Day 2027**
- "As loneliness rises worldwide, consumers are reimagining Valentine's Day rituals to foster a sense of belonging, validation and joy at a time when disconnection is the norm. Looking beyond romance, however, many consumers are also celebrating a wider spectrum of connections, from embracing self-love and platonic friendships to those with other significant others (OSOs), all of which offer brands opportunities to create products and experiences that meet these shifting consumer needs during this holiday event."
- "From 'Galentine's' gatherings to self-care retreats, consumers are leaning into the idea that love extends beyond romance, and that nurturing it in all its forms is vital to their wellbeing."

<https://www.wgsn.com/insight/article/6901207976e6074b32dd7b34/strategy/6902333276e6074b32df84d2>

- **Valentine's Day 2027 - Embrace the range of relationships worthy of celebration**

Showcase the real and the raw

Validate the messy reality of love by spotlighting imperfect moments, inviting candid vulnerability and designing experiences with transparent, realistic promises that reduce pressure and boost trust. 35% of Bumble users say that realistic and optimistic dating content makes them feel hopeful about their own love lives (Bumble). Highlight unpredictable, playful or imperfect moments, such as spontaneous gestures, quirky date ideas or shared moments of vulnerability or laughter. This normalises the ups and downs of relationships and connects with audiences on a sentimental level, allowing for a deeper understanding and emotional resonance.

Celebrate love beyond romance

Acknowledge that genuine closeness isn't limited to romantic relationships and often resides in the rhythm of daily life. Honour other significant others (OSOs), such as teachers, mentors, neighbours and business partners, by noticing and celebrating the small moments that turn ordinary interactions into meaningful memories. Considering that 86% of singles say humour, inside jokes and shared moments are key ways to show affection, brands should empower customers to showcase their appreciation for the most important people in their lives (Bumble).

Create moments to celebrate parents

Position Valentine's Day as an opportunity to recognise all meaningful relationships. Parents — whether mothers, fathers, step-parents or other caregivers — play a central role in shaping how people experience and share love, and they deserve recognition. By designing products and experiences that meet the emotional needs of these relationships, brands can offer tools that make gratitude tangible, from a quality time together to meaningful keepsakes. Highlight the importance of guidance and support which parents provide, and rethink traditional Valentine's messaging to celebrate the first love in people's lives.

- this article also shows examples of what brands did for their valentine's campaigns
 - ex. Sweethearts' "Love in this Economy" with messages about splitting rent as opposed to cute phrases around love in relationships

<https://www.wgsn.com/insight/article/6901207976e6074b32dd7b34/strategy/69b7fb97185c6063ea4db082>

- **Empower Positive Sensuality**

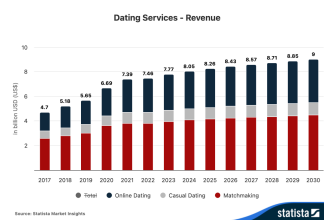
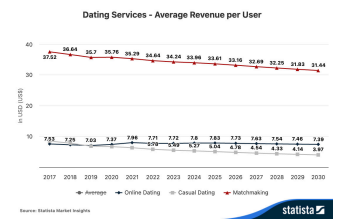
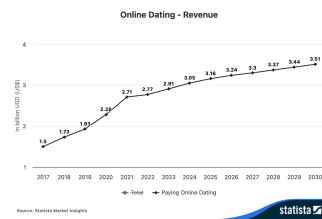
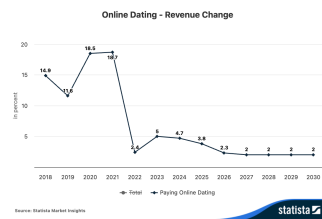
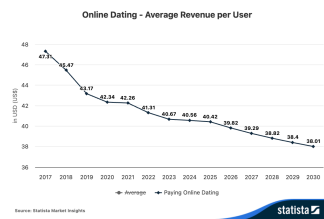
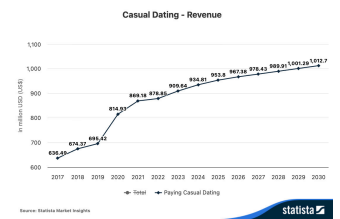
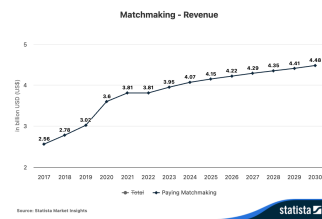
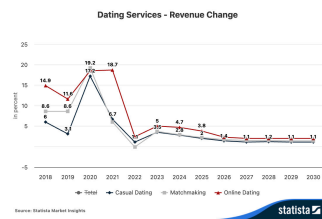
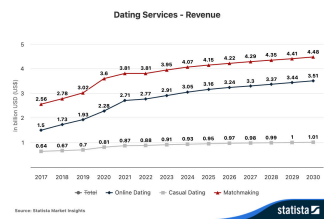
Position self-pleasure as a tool for self-awareness and emotional literacy

Reframe Valentine's Day beyond couple-centric narratives by encouraging individuals to explore their bodies, desires and boundaries without shame. Develop educational content, guided reflections, or expert-led conversations that frame solo intimacy as a healthy, informed practice grounded in consent and autonomy. Encourage open dialogue around pleasure as part of wellbeing, helping individuals build confidence, reduce stigma and understand their own needs before communicating them to others.

Use games to boost safe exploration and communication

Position games as tools for playful intimacy and emotional openness. Worldwide, 84% of Gen Z daters on Hinge are seeking new ways to build emotional intimacy (Hinge). Create card decks, conversation prompts, or light physical challenges designed for couples or new partners to explore their boundaries and fantasies in a structured, low-pressure environment. Foster curiosity, humour and communication.

Encourage imagination and romantic fantasy



<https://www.statista.com/outlook/emo/dating-services/online-dating/worldwide>

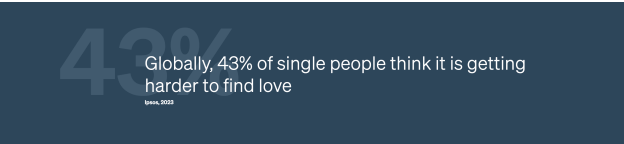
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<https://app.stylus.com/consumer-attitudes/three-new-ai-matchmaking-apps-streamline-online-dating>

<https://app.stylus.com/pop-culture-media/internet-trends-101-new-romance>



5: The Pulse of Palentines: Gals, Pals & Gaming Clans

For 2026, 20% of single American Gen Zers will be celebrating Valentine's Day's friends-focused equivalent, Galentine's/Palentine's (Savings.com, 2026). Brand strategies bringing new perspectives to platonic connections include Lush's Bestie Baskets, German meal kit company Hello Fresh and American pop culture news platform Betches' Galentine's home-hosting concept, and Finnish game developer Supercell's recasting of gaming clans as romcom-worthy relationships.

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6: New Spins on Self-Love

Self-love – and the associated rise in self-gifting – is another major driver in the Valentine's Day growth engine. In 2025, 60% of 18- to 24-year-old Americans planned to self-gift, up from 58% in 2024, with further increases expected in 2026 (CivicScience, 2025). Brand opportunities lie both in self-indulgence and self-care, presenting possibilities from high fashion to health and wellbeing.

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could this lead to gen Z focusing on things beside relationships?

1. Alphapreneurs' Growing Ambitions

Gen Alpha's entrepreneurial ambitions are expanding as they age. Ambitious members of this cohort are doing everything from pet sitting, reselling, and making money through online games (profiled in the Future Consumer Lifecycle 26/27: Gen Alpha) to co-creating compelling brands in collaboration with parents and experts.

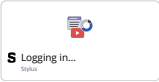
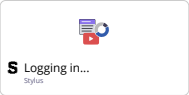
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5. Reclaiming Online Privacy

The ceaseless stream of content on social media is eroding many young people's sense of online community. As Gens Z and Alpha see fewer posts from real-life friends, they're switching to platforms that swap impersonal public attention for meaningful interactions. Smart brands are building private platforms where young people can connect with friends.

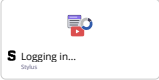
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does this mean less online dating?



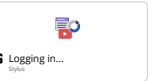
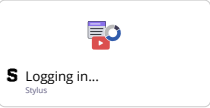
Here are the reasons. Social media is adding a level of surveillance to dating, leaving young people afraid that their dating stories will be ousted online.

Reproductive restrictions have made sex riskier, and a growing ideological divide between young men and women has complicated romance.



- **Overstimulation Drives Surly Moods:** People worldwide are contending with mental overwhelm. A six-country study found that 68% of people are frustrated with their perceived inability to focus, frequently accompanied by feelings of guilt, anxiety or disappointment (Human Clarity Institute, 2025). Meanwhile, people are keenly aware of how digital living influences their mental state. In the

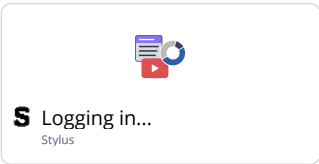
people are overwhelmed in other aspekst of life and tech is getting out of control, how is this going to affect dating online?



- **Social Media Heightens Vulnerability:** Half of Gen Z men and 45% of women say social media makes them more hesitant to open up on dates, as they feel watched by others – making them self-censor and worry about how they're perceived.

According to Heineken's research, Gen Z and millennials have the strongest desire to discover new places, have new experiences and meet new people; however, they struggle to go beyond their comfort zones. Twenty-one per cent are worried about going somewhere they wouldn't like, 18% say it's too hard to please all their friends, and 15% say they're overwhelmed by choice.

These choices have led young people to feel dissatisfied, with 59% admitting that they didn't feel their social life was as rewarding as it could be and 34% wishing that it involved more new experiences. Twenty-three percent of Gen Z respondents even felt that their social lives lack a certain 'spark.'



AI is increasingly becoming a tool for navigating dating, with 60% of 18–22-year-olds surprisingly open to guidance and many using it for opening lines or crafting responses.

Overall, Gen Z is seemingly seeking out low-risk intimacy in an era of heightened social scrutiny. So what do you think? Are you finding it hard to open up on dates?